

Creating a Policy to Tag Resources



Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
Status:	Final	Effective:	8/18/2026

1. Purpose

Provide instructions to create an Azure policy that copies a tag called PO from a subscription to resources as they are created and to remediate existing resources.

The mechanism is a single Azure Policy definition that uses the modify effect. When a resource is created or updated, Azure Policy writes the PO tag onto the resource using the value read from the containing subscription. Resources that already exist are brought into line afterwards by running a remediation task against the same assignment.

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3. Instructions

3.1. Important Notes

- Read the entire document carefully before executing, failure to address the prerequisites or missing a step may result in the policy failing.
- TD SYNEX recommends assigning this policy at the root management group level to ensure that it is applied to all current and future subscriptions.
- Policy compliance evaluation only runs once every 24 hours. The data displayed may be out of date. Do not do a remediation task until 24 hours after policy creation.
- The remediation task may not update all resources. After remediation, wait 24 hours then review the policy compliance. Manually add the PO value to resources that were not remediated.
- This document provides instructions for creating the policy at a management group level **OR** subscription level. Do not do both.
- If assigning the policy at the subscription level, it must be created and assigned to each subscription individually.

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3.2. Prerequisites

IMPORTANT: Read carefully, failure to address the prerequisites will result in the policy failing.

- **Owner on the management group or all subscriptions** where the definition and the assignment will live.
- **Owner at the assignment scope**, which is required to create the role assignment for the policy managed identity.
- The PO tag is already present, with the correct value, on each target subscription.
- A management group containing the target subscriptions, **if you want one assignment** to cover all of them rather than repeating the assignment per subscription.

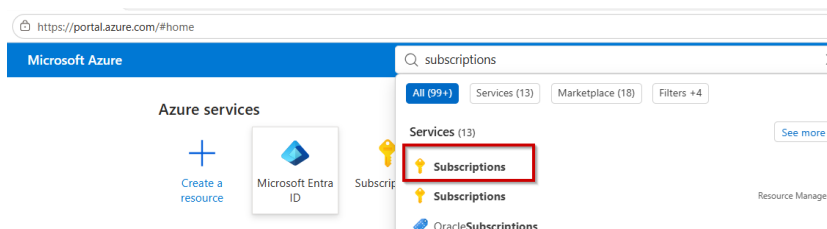
See: [Azure Management Groups](#)

A modify policy writes tags onto resources; it does not create the tag on the subscription itself. If a subscription carries no PO value, resources in that subscription are reported as compliant and nothing is written. That is the behavior you should want while a subscription tag is still being agreed upon, but it also means an empty subscription tag silently produces no result.

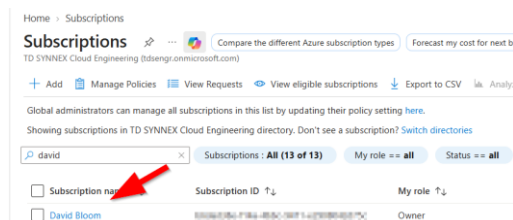
3.3. Verify Tag Exists

The policy reads its value from the subscription, so the source value has to be correct before anything is assigned. Confirm the tag on every subscription in scope and record the values.

1. Sign in to the [Azure portal](#).
2. Type *Subscriptions* into the global search bar, then select Subscriptions from the results.



3. Select a target subscription, then choose Tags in the left navigation menu.

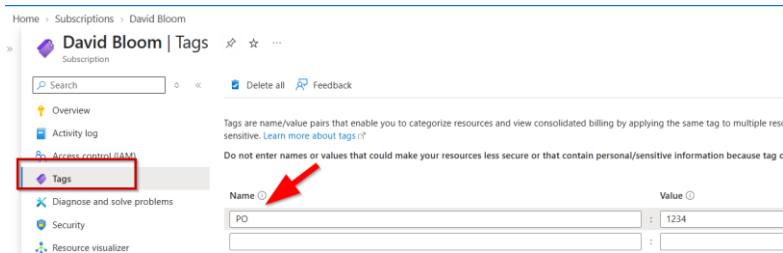


4. Confirm that a tag named PO exists and that its value matches the purchase order the subscription is billed against. Azure treats tag names as case-insensitive for lookup but stores the case you type, **so enter it as PO in upper case for consistency across reporting**.

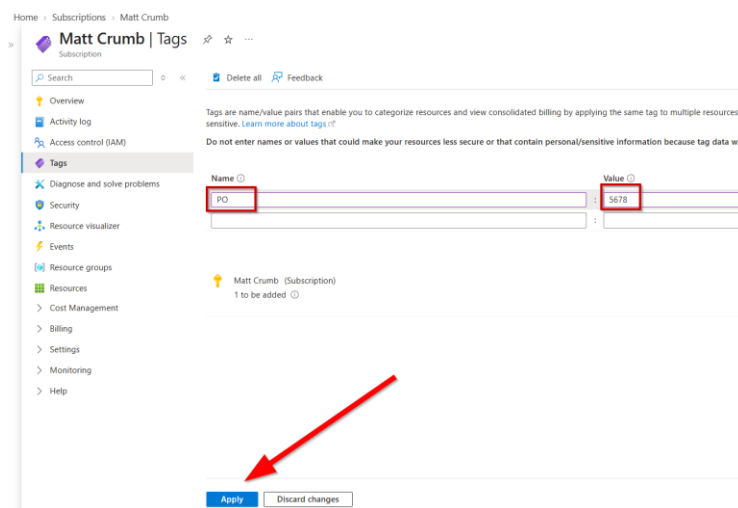
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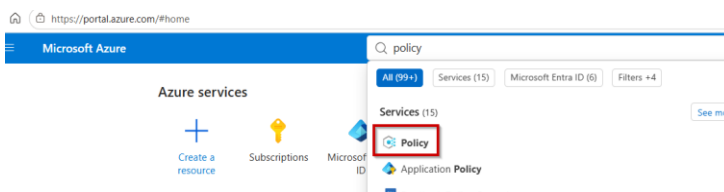
5. If the tag is missing, type *PO* in the Name column and the purchase order number in the Value column, then select Apply.



6. Repeat for every subscription to which the policy will be assigned.

3.4. Create the Policy Definition

1. Log Into the [Azure portal](https://portal.azure.com/#home).
2. Type *Policy* into the global search bar and open the Policy service.

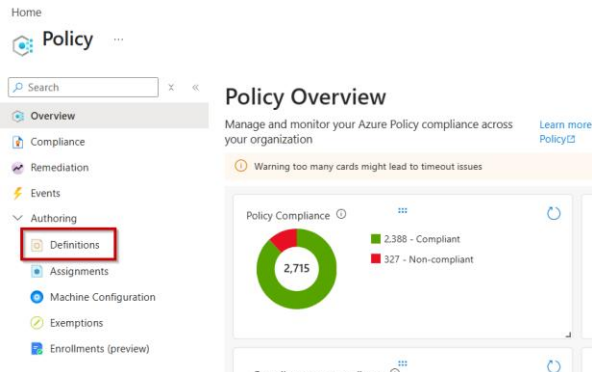


3. Under Authoring in the left menu, select Definitions.

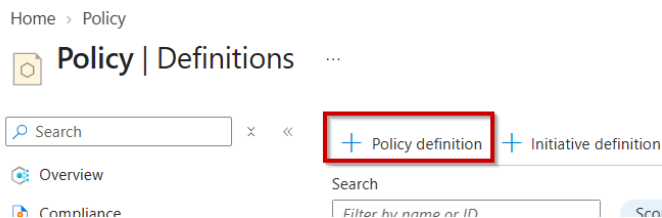
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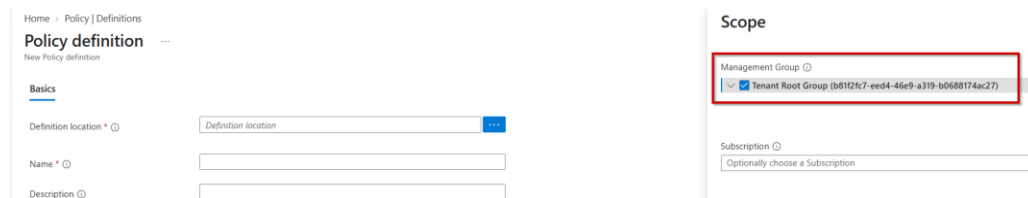
4. Select + Policy definition on the command bar at the top of the blade.



IMPORTANT: only follow step 5 **or** 6 below. Do not follow both steps.

TD SYNEX recommends using management groups. Creating management groups is beyond the scope of this document. More information about creating and using management groups may be found at: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/governance/management-groups/overview>

5. **If using management groups**, for Definition location, select the ellipsis button and choose the management group that contains your target subscriptions. Saving the definition at management group scope is what allows a single assignment to cover every subscription beneath it. A definition saved in one subscription cannot be assigned to another. The user must have Owner role on the management group.



6. **If using individual subscriptions**, for Definition location, select the ellipsis button and choose the first subscription. A definition saved in one subscription cannot be assigned to another. **Repeat** the following steps for each subscription.

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Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
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Home > Policy | Definitions

Policy definition ...

New Policy definition

Basics

Definition location * ⓘ

Definition location

Name * ⓘ

Description ⓘ

Scope

Management Group ⓘ

Tenant Root Group (b812fc7-ee44-46e9-a319-b0688174ac27)

Subscription ⓘ

David Bloom

7. Enter *"Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription"* in the Name field and paste the description text below into the Description field.

Description: *"Adds or replaces the PO tag with the value from the containing subscription when a resource is created or updated. Existing resources can be remediated with a remediation task"*

Home > Policy | Definitions

Policy definition ...

New Policy definition

Basics

Definition location * ⓘ

Tenant Root Group

Name * ⓘ

Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription

Description ⓘ

Adds or replaces the PO tag with the value from the containing subscription when a resource is created or updated. Existing resources can be remediated with a remediation task

8. For Category, select Use existing and choose Tags.

Category ⓘ

☐ Create new ☒ Use existing

Tags

9. In the Policy Rule editor, **replace** the sample JSON with the mode, parameters, and policyRule properties shown in Appendix A.

Policy rule

[Import sample policy definition from GitHub](#)

[Learn more about policy definition structure](#)

```
1 {
2   "mode": "Indexed",
3   "parameters": {},
4   "policyRule": {
5     "if": {
6       "allOf": [
7         {
8           "field": "tags['PO']",
9           "notEquals": "[subscription().tags['PO']]"
10        },
11        {
12          "value": "[empty(subscription().tags['PO'])]",
13          "equals": false
14        }
15      ]
16    },
17    "then": {
18      "effect": "modify",
19      "details": {
20        "roleDefinitionIds": [
21          "/providers/microsoft.authorization/roleDefinitions/4a9ae827-6dc8-4573-8ac7-8239d42aa03f"
22        ],
23        "operations": [
24          {
25            "operation": "addOrReplace",
26            "field": "tags['PO']",
27            "value": "[subscription().tags['PO']]"
28          }
29        ]
30      }
31    }
32  }
33 }
```

Creating a Policy to Tag Resources

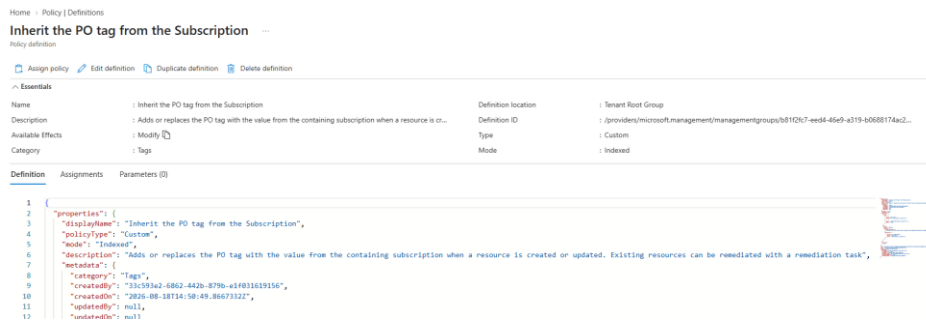


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10. In Role Definitions, leave Tag Contributor selected.
11. Select Save.



12. The blade closes, the definition list refreshes, and the new definition appears with a Type of Custom.

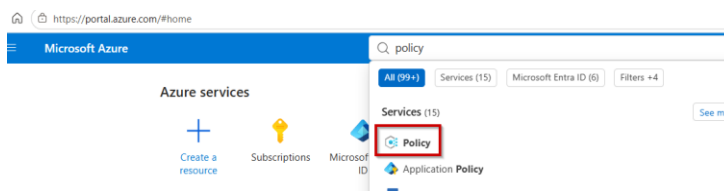


Note: The GUID in roleDefinitionIds (4a9ae827-6dc8-4573-8ac7-8239d42aa03f) is the Tag Contributor role. This is the least privileged role to accomplish the task.

IMPORTANT: You will only assign the policy at the management group level **OR** to each subscription individually. Do either 3.4 or 3.5, **not both**.

3.5. Assigning the Policy to a Management Group

1. Log Into the [Azure portal](#).
2. Type *Policy* into the global search bar and open the Policy service.

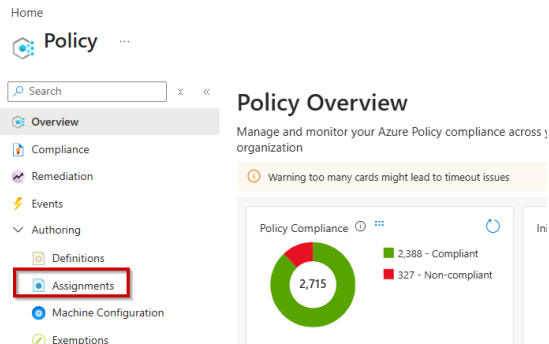


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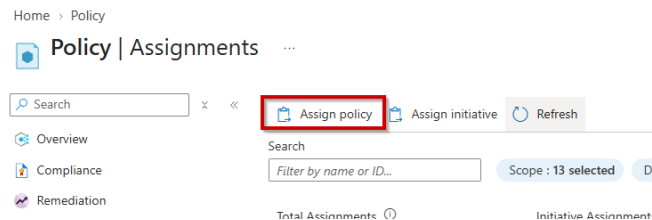


Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
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- Under Authoring in the left menu, select Assignments.



- Select Assign policy on the command bar.

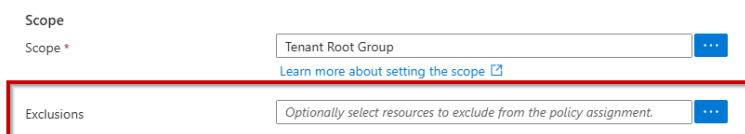


- On the Basics tab, set Scope by selecting the ellipsis and choosing the management group that contains the target subscriptions. We recommend using the root management group.

Click Select.



- Leave Exclusions empty unless the scope contains a subscription or resource group that must not inherit the tag, in which case add it now. Exclusions are easier to justify at assignment time than to retrofit after a remediation run.



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7. Select the ellipsis next to Policy definition. Search for *Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription* definition. Then select Add.

Home > Policy | Assignments

Assign policy ...

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

Scope

Scope * ...

Exclusions

Resource selectors (Expand)

Basics

Policy definition * ...

Available Definitions

Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription

Policy type: All policy types Category: All categories

Policy name	Latest version	Category	Type
☒ Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription	1.0.0	Tags	Custom

1 out of 1 policies selected

Previous Next **Review + create** **Add** Cancel

8. Set Assignment name to something durable, such as *Inherit PO tag from Subscription*. This name appears in compliance reports and in the remediation blade, so avoid ticket numbers or dates.

Assignment name * ⓘ

9. Set the Description or leave it blank.

Description

10. Leave Policy enforcement set to Default. Setting it to Do not enforce evaluates compliance without writing any tags.

Policy enforcement ⓘ

☒ Default

☐ Do not enforce

☐ Enroll

11. Select Next to open the Parameters tab. The definition has no parameters, so this tab is empty.

Basics **Parameters** Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

✓ This policy has no parameters.

12. Select Next to open the Remediation tab. Note that remediation is not supported when assigning policies at the management group level.

Basics Parameters **Remediation** Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

By default, this assignment will only take effect on newly created resources. Existing resources can be updated via a remediation task after the policy is assigned. For deployIfNotExists policies, the remediation task will deploy the specified template. For modify policies, the remediation task will edit tags on the existing resources. [Learn more about Remediation Tasks.](#)

ⓘ This policy does not support remediation tasks. Policies must have remediation support in order to create a remediation task.

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13. Select Next to open Managed identity tab.

Home > Policy | Assignments

Assign policy ...

Basics Parameters Remediation **Managed identity** Non-compliance messages Review + create

Managed identity

Policies with the deployIfNotExists and modify effect types need the ability to deploy resources and edit tags on existing resources respectively. Policies that use external sources to determine enforcement outcomes need the ability to invoke these endpoints. To enable these abilities, choose between an existing user assigned managed identity or creating a system assigned managed identity. [Learn more about Managed identity.](#)

Create a Managed Identity ☒

Type of Managed Identity①

☒ System assigned managed identity

☐ User assigned managed identity

System assigned identity location (US) East US

Permissions

This identity will also be given the following permissions: Tag Contributor

☐ Role assignments (permissions) are created based on the role definitions specified in the policies.

14. The Create a Managed Identity checkbox should be checked. Without this, the assignment reports compliance but never writes a tag.

Create a Managed Identity ☒

15. Choose System assigned managed identity unless your organization standardized on user assigned identities, in which case select the existing identity. User assigned managed identity is out of the scope of this document.

16. Set Managed Identity Location to a region you already operate in, for example East US. This controls only where the identity object is stored, **not** where the policy applies.

Type of Managed Identity①

☒ System assigned managed identity

☐ User assigned managed identity

System assigned identity location (US) East US

17. Check the Permissions box on the same tab. It shows the role the definition requests: Tag Contributor.

Permissions

This identity will also be given the following permissions: Tag Contributor

18. Select Next, optionally enter text on the Non-compliance messages tab, then select Next and Review + create.

Creating a Policy to Tag Resources



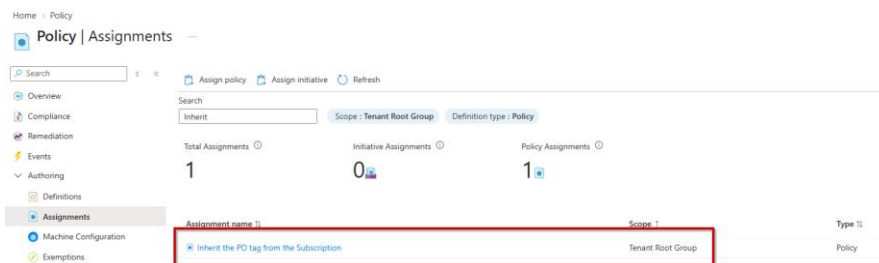
Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
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Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

Non-compliance messages help users understand why a resource is not compliant with the policy. The message will be displayed when a resource is denied and in the evaluation details of any non-compliant resource.

Non-compliance message

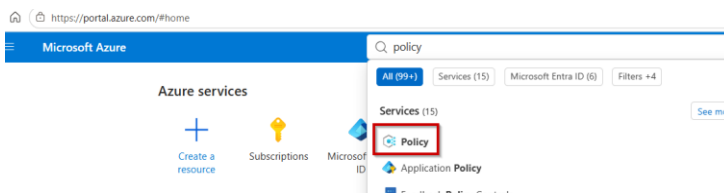
19. Select Create. The assignment appears in the Assignments list within a few seconds.



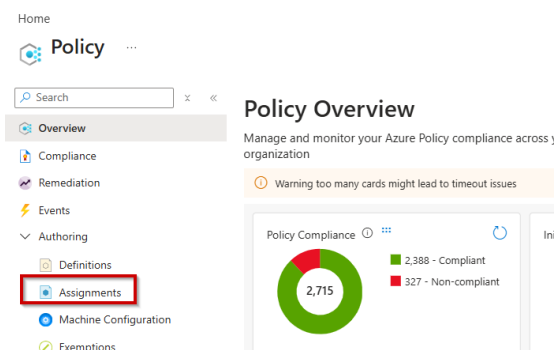
3.6. Assigning the Policy to a Subscription

Important: This must be done for each subscription. We recommend assigning at the management group level not at individual subscriptions.

1. Log Into the [Azure portal](#).
2. Type *Policy* into the global search bar and open the Policy service.



3. Under Authoring in the left menu, select Assignment.

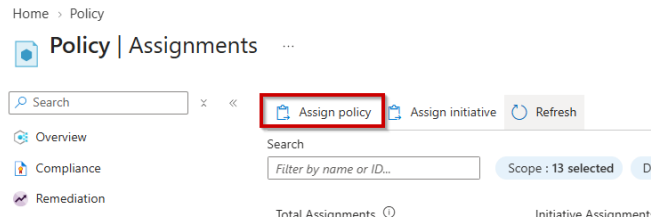


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Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
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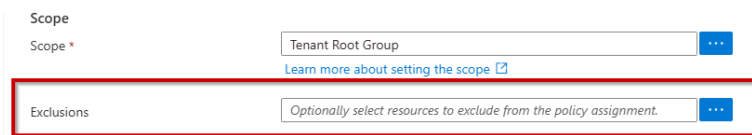
4. Select Assign policy on the command bar.



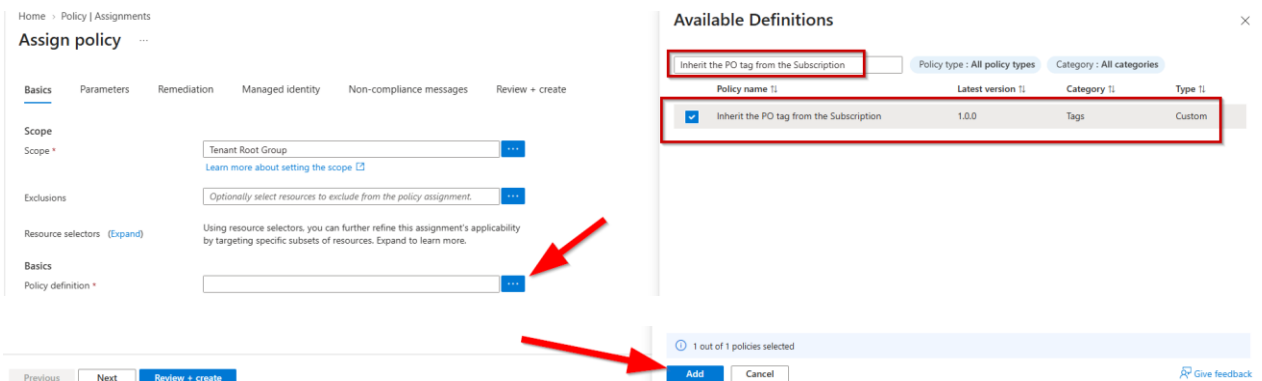
5. On the Basics tab, set Scope by selecting the ellipsis and choose the subscription. You will need to repeat the entire procedure for each subscription.



6. Leave Exclusions empty unless the scope contains a subscription or resource group that must not inherit the tag, in which case add it now. Exclusions are easier to justify at assignment time than to retrofit after a remediation run.



7. Select the ellipsis next to Policy definition. Search for *Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription* definition. Then select Add.



8. Set Assignment name to something durable, such as *Inherit PO tag from Subscription*. This name appears in compliance reports and in the remediation blade, so avoid ticket numbers or dates.

Assignment name * ⓘ

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9. Set the Description or leave it blank.

Description

10. Leave Policy enforcement set to Default. Setting it to Do not enforce evaluates compliance without writing any tags.

Policy enforcement ⓘ

- ☒ Default
- ☐ Do not enforce
- ☐ Enroll

11. Select Next to open the Parameters tab. The definition has no parameters, so this tab is empty.

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

✓ This policy has no parameters.

12. Select Next to open the Remediation tab. Check Create a remediation task and ensure *Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription* is chosen as the Policy to remediate.

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

By default, this assignment will only take effect on newly created resources. Existing resources can be updated via a remediation task after the policy is assigned. For deployIfNotExists policies, the remediation task will deploy the specified template. For modify policies, the remediation task will edit tags on the existing resources. [Learn more about Remediation Tasks.](#)

☒ Create a remediation task

Policy to remediate

Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription

ⓘ A remediation task will be created to bring existing non-compliant resources into compliance after the assignment is created.

13. Select Next to open Managed identity tab.

Home > Policy | Assignments

Assign policy ...

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

Managed Identity

Policies with the deployIfNotExists and modify effect types need the ability to deploy resources and edit tags on existing resources respectively. Policies that use external sources to determine enforcement outcomes need the ability to invoke these endpoints. To enable these abilities, choose between an existing user assigned managed identity or creating a system assigned managed identity. [Learn more about Managed Identity.](#)

Create a Managed Identity



Type of Managed Identity ⓘ

- ☒ System assigned managed identity
- ☐ User assigned managed identity

System assigned identity location

(US) East US

Permissions

This identity will also be given the following permissions:

Tag Contributor

ⓘ Role assignments (permissions) are created based on the role definitions specified in the policies.

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14. The **Create a Managed Identity** checkbox should be checked. Without this, the assignment reports compliance but never writes a tag.

Create a Managed Identity



15. Choose **System assigned managed identity** unless your organization standardized on user assigned identities, in which case select the existing identity. User assigned managed identity is out of the scope of this document.

16. Set **Managed Identity Location** to a region you already operate in, for example East US. This controls only where the identity object is stored, not where the policy applies.

Type of Managed Identity^①

☒ System assigned managed identity

☐ User assigned managed identity

System assigned identity location

(US) East US

17. Check the **Permissions** box on the same tab. It shows the role the definition requests: **Tag Contributor**.

Permissions

This identity will also be given the following permissions:

Tag Contributor

18. Select the **Create a remediation task** checkbox if you want existing resources corrected as part of this assignment. You can also leave it clear and create remediation tasks separately, which is what Section 3.6 describes and what most change-controlled environments prefer. We recommend leaving it unchecked.

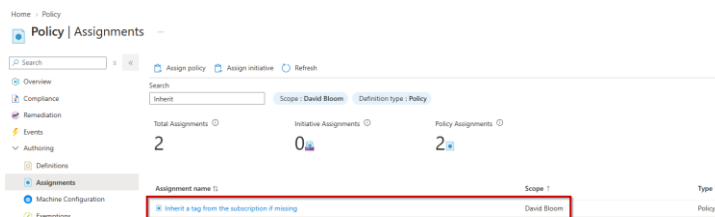
19. Select **Next**, optionally enter text on the **Non-compliance messages** tab, then select **Next** and **Review + create**.

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity **Non-compliance messages** Review + create

Non-compliance messages help users understand why a resource is not compliant with the policy. The message will be displayed when a resource is denied and in the evaluation details of any non-compliant resource.

Non-compliance message

20. Select **Create**. The assignment appears in the **Assignments** list within a few seconds.



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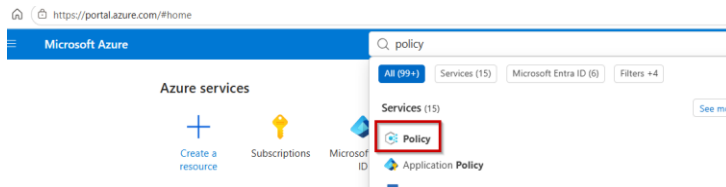


Type:	4. Instructions	Version:	1.0
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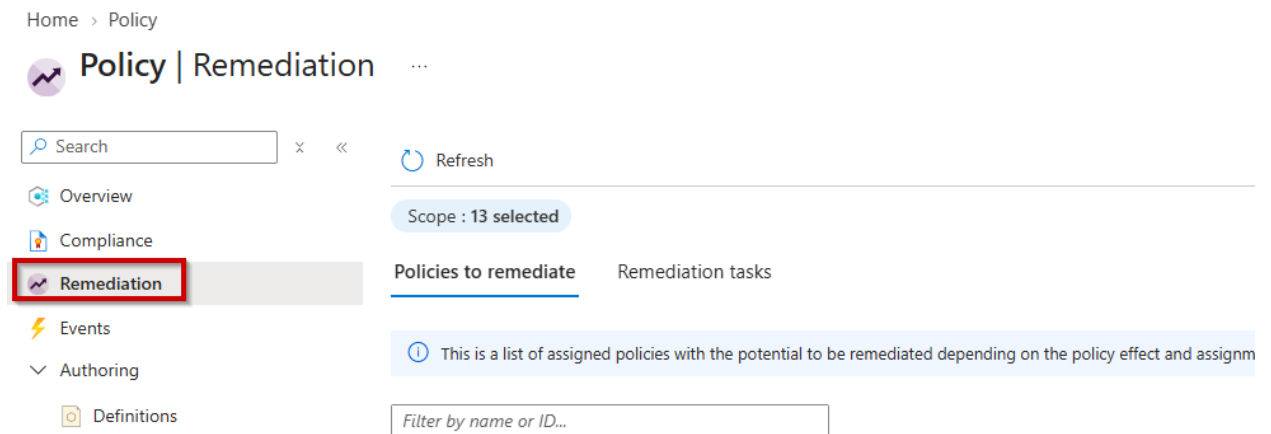
3.7. Create a Remediation Task

IMPORTANT: Wait 24 hours after the policy has been assigned before remediating. This will allow the first compliance evaluation to be completed.

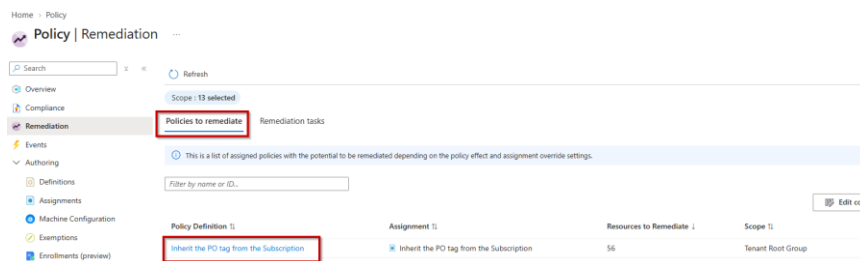
1. Log Into the [Azure portal](#).
2. Type *Policy* into the global search bar and open the Policy service.



3. Select Remediation.



4. On the Policies to remediate tab, find the assignment named Inherit PO tag from subscription. This tab lists all the policies eligible for remediation, so if the policy is absent, either the assignment has no managed identity or the first evaluation has not finished.



5. Select the policy name to open the New remediation task blade.

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Home > Policy | Remediation

New remediation task ...

Remediation action

Policy to remediate

Inherit the PO tag from the Subscription

[View definition](#)

Description:

Adds or replaces the PO tag with the value from the containing subscription when a resource is created or updated. Existing resources can be remediated with a remediation task.

Applicable resources to remediate

Scope : Tenant Root Group

Remediation Option

☒ Select location(s) for this remediation to take place

Locations

All selected

6. Confirm the Scope. Narrow it to a single subscription or resource group for the first run, then widen it once the result is proven.

Applicable resources to remediate

Scope : David Bloom

7. Leave Re-evaluate resource compliance before remediating clear for the first run. Selecting it re-checks every resource before writing, which is slower but avoids acting on compliance data that has gone stale since the last evaluation.

Remediation Option

☒ Select location(s) for this remediation to take place

Locations

All selected

☐ Re-evaluate resource compliance before remediating

☐ Select specific resources to remediate

8. Review the Resources to remediate list and the count above it. That is the exact set of resources the task will change, so capture it if you need a change record.

Example non-compliant resources

Maximum of 250 non-compliant resources can be shown for this policy in the specified scope and location(s). This may not be the another task at the same scope and location(s) after the current task is completed.

Name	Resource type
proj-default	Microsoft.CognitiveServices/accounts/projects
jmoaipproject	Microsoft.CognitiveServices/accounts
jmoedocintel	Microsoft.CognitiveServices/accounts

9. Accept the defaults failure threshold unless you have a reason to throttle the run.

Remediation settings

Failure Threshold (percentage)

100

Resource Count

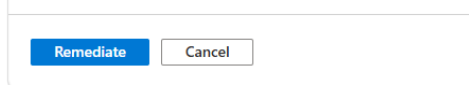
500

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10. Select Remediate. The task will run immediately.



11. The time required to remediate varies. After some time, check the resources to determine if the remediation was successful. Failed remediation is usually related to managed identities.

3.8. Support

Should issues arise with creating the policies, the TD SYNEX professional services team is available for a consulting engagement. Break/fix support is available from cspsupport@tdsynnex.com.

The TD SYNEX pre-sales engineering team cannot consult on implementation of Azure policies.

4. Associated Documents

- [Microsoft Learn | Azure Policy Overview](#)
- [Microsoft Learn | Remediate Azure Policies](#)
- [Microsoft Learn | Create Azure Policies](#)
- [Microsoft Learn | Azure Management Groups Overview](#)

5. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

6. Document Revision History

Number	Effective Date	Revision History	Author
1.0	8/18/2026	Initial Draft	David Bloom

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7. Appendix A – Policy Definition for Policy Editor

The following text is inserted into the Azure Policy Editor to create the custom policy.

```
{
  "mode": "Indexed",
  "parameters": {},
  "policyRule": {
    "if": {
      "allOf": [
        {
          "field": "tags['PO']",
          "notEquals": "[subscription().tags['PO']]"
        },
        {
          "value": "[subscription().tags['PO']]",
          "notEquals": ""
        }
      ]
    },
    "then": {
      "effect": "modify",
      "details": {
        "roleDefinitionIds": [
          "/providers/microsoft.authorization/roleDefinitions/4a9ae827-6dc8-4573-8ac7-8239d42aa03f"
        ],
        "operations": [
          {
            "operation": "addOrReplace",
            "field": "tags['PO']",
            "value": "[subscription().tags['PO']]"
          }
        ]
      }
    }
  }
}
```